

PATRIOT GAMES

After England, she's out to conquer America. Come Independence Day, **Shilpa Shetty** will be the Grand Marshal at the India Day Parade in New York, the largest I-Day celebration abroad. Since nothing but the best will do, she will wear Tarun Tahiliani. It worked for her in *Bigg Boss*, remember?



Her acting abilities haven't made heads turn in India but **Mallika Sherawat** seems to have wowed America. Currently in Los Angeles for the post-production of her film *Hisss*, she will be made an honorary citizen of the city on the eve of Independence Day. What's next? The green card?



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YASBANT NIGI

BAN WAGON

Decades after her memorable performance as Basanti, *tangewali* Hema Malini is battling to clear Mumbai of horses and horse carts. In a letter written on behalf of PETA India, the veteran actor has requested Mumbai Municipal Commissioner Jairaj Phatak to ban horse carts from plying on Mumbai streets. The municipal commissioner is clearly not impressed. "No decision has been taken yet. There will be a discussion on the subject," says Phatak. Hooves up for the effort at least.

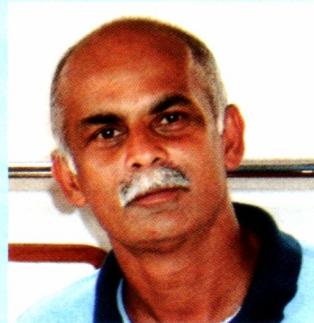
Healthy and Wise

She may have given up a busy actor's life to play mommy, but Kajol is doing everything else to stay in the public eye. First it was an advertisement for a candy and then toothpaste. This time the actor is lending her face to promote Yakult Danone, a probiotic health drink, in the Indian market. "Being a mother and a wife, for me my family comes first; making me conscious of their health care needs." More like a healthy dose of publicity for the "complete woman".

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THE BIG SAIL



He's trying to be India's Ted Turner by attempting to sail around the world in a yacht. Commander **Dilip Donde** will be the first Indian to attempt such a feat for the Navy's prestigious project Sagar Parikrama. Donde, 42, will sail atop Mhadei, his specially designed fibreglass yacht, to Australia, New Zealand, the Falkland Islands and Capetown before returning to Mumbai in about nine months. "This venture will establish India's name in the international boat-making industry," says Donde. Bon voyage, we say.

